

Keep EURUSD shorts this summer

Key takeaways

- On 20 May we went short euro via a 1.15-1.13 put spread. We remain short into summer: techs + fundamentals point to downside.
- Technicals: Post NFP, euro broke trend line support. A head and shoulders top is still forming. And 2018 is still repeating.
- Fundamentals: Relative data flow underpriced, amid growing risk to USD-supportive monetary policy repricing.

View: Keep EURUSD shorts this summer

On May 20, we recommended positioning for euro weakness into summer via a EURUSD 1.15/1.13 3m put spread (spot 1.1610, vols 6.22%/6.72%) at a cost of 0.3591% (current: 0.47%). We remain short. See report: [Six reasons to short euro 20 May 2026](#)

Technical: Euro broke support, bias is to fade bounces

One immediate market response to the latest US payrolls release was a decline in euro, which broke an uptrend line and reinforced our bearish view. On June 8, euro tested the psychological 1.15 support level and has begun to bounce. We prefer to fade rebounds and continue to look for renewed downside. On the weekly chart, euro continues to form the right shoulder of a head and shoulders top, with neckline support at 1.1411–1.1392. A decisive break below this zone would materially increase downside risk.

Finally, DXY behaviour during President Trump's second term continues to track his first. In 2018, the second year of term one, DXY bottomed in the first half and rallied in the second. DXY is now attempting to base, with a daily close above 100.51 needed to confirm a renewed uptrend and continuing repeating 2018.

Fundamentals: relative data vs. geopolitical wish-casting

There is a case to be made for EUR/USD to potentially trade through our Q2 forecast of 1.14, which is also just below its 12-month lows. The growth divergence between the US and EA is notable and arguably being underpriced by rates markets.

But hope for a peace agreement in the Middle East has prevented larger themes from taking hold. Even as there has been some associated reprieve in energy markets, upside risks points to downside risks to the EUR (from a terms-of-trade perspective). This suggests a real possibility of further USD supportive Fed repricing, while ECB hikes could prove counter-productive for the EUR.

In the meantime, the market will likely be in a more of a holding pattern as these next two weeks bring the May CPI report (this Wed) and the first FOMC under Chair Warsh (next Wed). Any hint of further upside pressure from the data, or a less assertive dovish tone from Chair Warsh could serve as the next (non-Iran related) catalyst for a USD rally.

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Keep EUR shorts on this summer

EURUSD: Bearish trend line breakdown

Post strong US payroll data, euro broke trend line support

Following stronger-than-expected US payrolls data on June 5, EURUSD sold off sharply, breaking below trendline support and falling to its lowest level since early April. This breakdown reinforces our bearish bias.

On June 8, EURUSD tested 1.15 and has since started to bounce. In the near term, we view former support as resistance, beginning at 1.1576 (May 21 low) and extending up to the broken trendline near 1.16.

We continue to favor selling EUR into rallies, including the current bounce. Ideally, EURUSD does not post a daily close above the prior range resistances, which include the 50-day SMA, 200-day SMA, and downtrend line in the 1.1671–1.1685 area.

Chart 4: EURUSD bearish trend line breakdown, test of psychological support at 1.15, bounce to resistance should be faded.

Daily candles, 50d SMA, 200d SMA, Ichimoku Cloud RSI, MACD, Fibonacci levels



EURUSD Currency (EUR-USD X-RATE) EURUSD Daily Daily 18SEP2020-09JUN2026

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Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg

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DXY in 2024-2026 has been repeating 2016-2018

If the DXY continues to repeat Trump's term 1 trend, the DXY rallies in 2H26.

DXY price action continues to closely mirror the 2016–2018 post-election cycle, suggesting further upside risk if the pattern holds. We're on watch for a daily close above 100.51 to confirm a repeat bottom rhyming with 2018 and further upside. This would be the highest daily close since May 2025, eclipsing that of March 30, 2026.

Following the November 2016 election, DXY broke out of a multi-year range and rallied ~6.4%, before forming a head-and-shoulders top and declining through 2017. The index then bottomed in 1Q18, broke higher in late April, and went on to rally a further ~6.6% into August 2018.

A similar sequence has unfolded after the November 2024 election, DXY broke out and rallied ~6.3%, then formed a top and declined through 2025. In 1Q26, DXY established a key low and has begun to base.

If this analogue continues to hold, a confirmed breakout from the current base would point to a renewed USD uptrend, with potential for DXY to rally toward 103–105 in the coming months.

Chart 5: Below we compare the DXY trend in 2016 through 2018 vs 2024 through today. They are tracking closely and, if they continue to, the DXY will soon bottom and rally this summer and euro will decline.

Daily line chart of closing prices. Top panel is 2016-2018, bottom is 2024-2026.



Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg

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Fundamentals: Relative data vs. geopolitical wish-casting

As the EUR/USD's mostly narrow 12-month range has endured even though the start of the Iran war, relative economic data performance has continued to shift in the USD's favor (Exhibit 2). This was reinforced last Friday, by the US employment report, which served as the latest example of a resilient (if not strengthening) labor market, serving to push the pair towards the post-April ceasefire lows (Exhibit 1, see report: [Rates & FX: World Cup, labor, markets 08 June 2026](#)).

Still, this comes against a backdrop of continued hope for an eventual peace agreement, which has prevented the market from more materially trading off growth and/or rate differentials. And even as anticipations mount for an eventual resolution to the Iran war, the Strait of Hormuz remains closed, keeping energy prices elevated (albeit well past peak for now). Energy inventory issues will likely persist well after any hypothetical agreement is reached. In Europe, the rise in gas prices – while quite small compared to that of 2022 – remains a source of stagflationary concern. (Exhibit 5)

Talk of Fed hikes getting louder, while durability of ECB hikes in question

At the onset of the war, the market was quick to price the ECB (and several other G10 central banks) for eventual hikes to address the global inflation shock. At the same time, entrenched expectations for a more structurally dovish Fed prevented such an assertive adjustment in the US rates. Data flow on both sides of the Fed's mandate has started to change this.

Yet the market remains priced for even more hikes by the ECB, which for now has also mitigated a correction lower in the pair. (Exhibit 3; Exhibit 4) But given a more anemic growth backdrop, this isn't necessarily a bullish sign for the EUR, as eventual ECB tightening could be short-lived, and/or risk a policy mistake (see report: [Global FX weekly: A game of two halves 05 June 2026](#)).

At the same time, even if the market is right to expect Chair Warsh to resist hikes, the Fed's hand could easily be forced by a combination of ongoing inflationary pressure, further labor improvement and broader easing of financial conditions (ie. resilient equities). While markets reflect some likelihood of a hike this year, the vast majority of Fed forecasters (in Bloomberg) have yet to call for any (Exhibit 6).

(Fundamental) bottom line

Fundamentally, there is a case to be made for the EUR/USD pair to at least trade through our Q2 forecast of 1.14, which is also just below its 12-month lows. The growth divergence between the US and EA is notable, and arguably being underpriced by rates markets.

But hope for a peace agreement in the Middle East has prevented larger themes from taking hold. Even as there has been some associated reprieve in energy markets, upside risks point to downside risks to the EUR (from a terms-of-trade perspective). This suggests a real possibility of further USD supportive Fed repricing, while ECB hikes could prove counter-productive for the EUR.

In the meantime, the market will likely be in a more of a holding pattern as the next two weeks bring the May CPI report (this Wed) and the first FOMC under Chair Warsh (next Wed). Any hint of further upside pressure from the data, or a less assertive dovish tone from Chair Warsh could serve as the next (non-Iran related) catalyst for a dollar rally.

Exhibit 1: USD still trading within its previous 12m range, while labor surprise measures reach fresh multi-year highs

DXY & Bloomberg US Labor Surprise Index

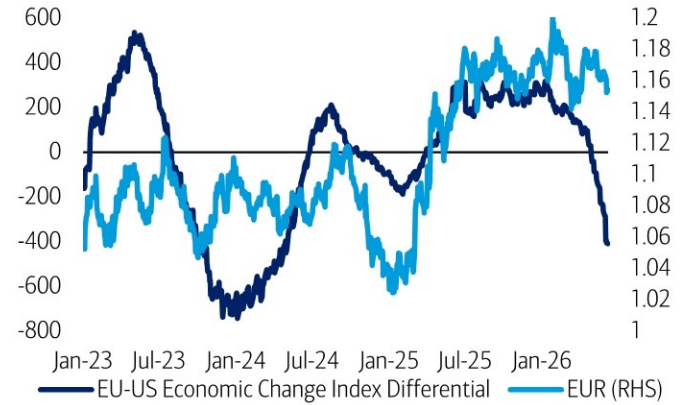


Source: Bloomberg; BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 2: Relative US vs. Euro area data trends have been stark, suggesting further space for the EUR to depreciate further

Economic Change Indices: EA - USA

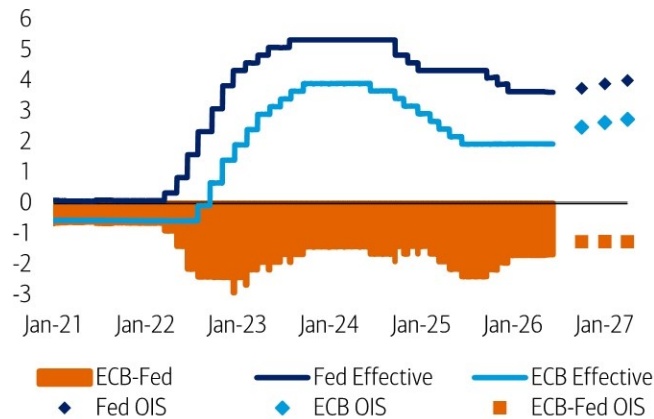


Source: Bloomberg; BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 3: Policy differentials now priced for modest but steady narrowing (towards EUR)...

Fed & ECB policy rate

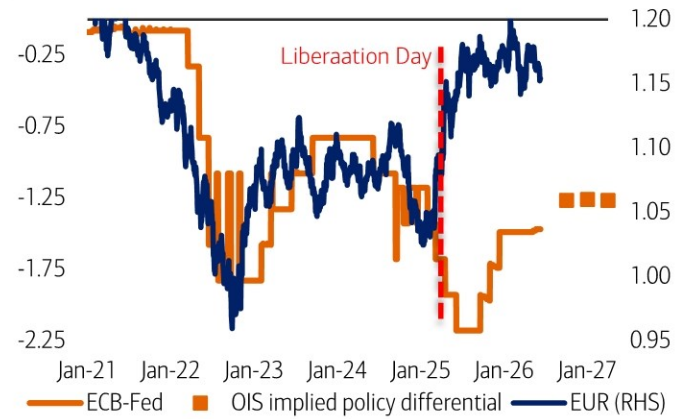


Source: Bloomberg; BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 4: ... Yet post-“Liberation Day” structural break between FX and policy rates has continued

ECB-Fed policy differential (and OIS Implied) vs. EUR



Source: Bloomberg; BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 5: Since the closure of the Strait of Hormuz, the EUR has remained resilient relative to the upward pressure on gas prices

European Gas (TZT) & EUR (inverted)

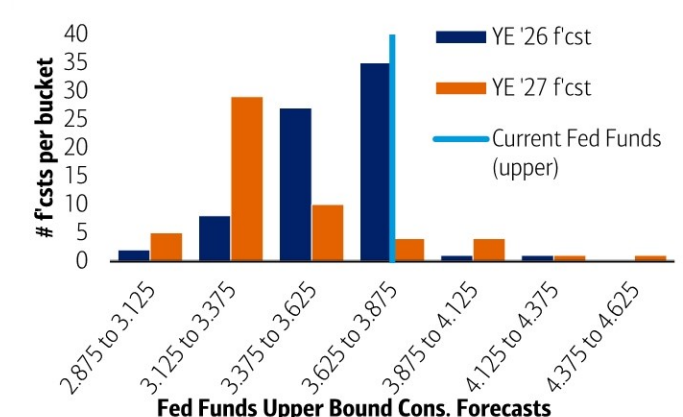


Source: Bloomberg; BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 6: Vast majority of Fed forecasters have still been reluctant to call for hikes in 2026 or 2027

Histogram of YE '26 and YE '27 Fed funds forecasts



Source: Bloomberg; BofA Global Research

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